The Journals Of She-Ra

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/71590491.

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She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

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by TheStarGayzingEtherianCollection (TheStarGayzingEtherian)

Summary

While preparing to put some of Finn's old things up in the attic, Catra and Glimmer make quite the discovery about Adora. (Catradora, Canon, Fluff)

Notes

See the end of the work for notes

It had been a long time since Catra had felt the need to put stuff up in the attic. To be honest, it had been so long, she'd forgotten there even *was* an attic in the suite of her's and Adora's wing of the castle. But of course, when Glimmer had ordered this place built for them and whatever family they would have, she of course spared no expense and at least right now, Catra was thankful for the extra space above her's and Adora's heads.

As she placed the long ladder at the foot of the attic door, she looked around, seeing the large piles of boxes to go up there. Fortunately for Catra, she was at least getting some help in lugging all these old boxes up there. As she was about to head up, she looked over her shoulder, seeing Glimmer smirking and folding her arms about her. She knew that look on her face all too well.

"Still sure you don't want me teleporting you up there, Horde Scum?" she teased.

"Look, just because I'm at the tail end of my thirties here, Sparkles, doesn't mean I don't suddenly not want to stay in shape. Besides, I've got at least another five years before my back starts *really* hating me."

"Fair enough, just be prepared for me to say I told you when you're begging for me to use a healing spell after you throw your back out lugging all that stuff up there," Glimmer giggled.

"Yeah well, not all of us have big flowy wings to carry us," Catra snarked back. Glimmer's wings had finally sprouted out a couple of years after her mother had been rescued and just like Angella's, they were beautifully glorious, shimmering with magical pink light. She and Adora had spent quite a few nights cocooned in them when Glimmer was spending a night in their room.

Melog was also there, Catra's constant companion as always willing to help out and Catra was thankful she had two friends with telekinesis aiding her in this herculean task.

Catra then looked around. "Hey, have you seen Finn? They should be-"

"Right here, Mama!" Finn chirped, carrying one of the boxes out of their room. Finn by this point was now a teenager, fourteen going on fifteen in a few more months. Catra sighed a little. It seemed like her little kitten was growing up faster every day. Well, Finn wasn't exactly little anymore. Her child never let their mother live down the fact that they were now a few inches taller than her. Of course they inherited the tall gene from Adora. Glimmer could relate. Her daughter Twilight had also inherited the tall gene from Bow.

Catra grinned. "There you are! I was wondering if you'd actually show up, considering this is all your old stuff we're putting up in the attic."

"Do we really have to?" Finn wondered.

"Look, Finn, you haven't played with a lot of this stuff since you were crawling and mewing. It can't stay in your room forever. But we're not getting rid of any of it, I promise, just putting it somewhere safe."

"Alright... but just so you know, I'm still keeping Lil' Swifty."

Catra rolled her eyes with a smile. Even though they were a teenager now, Finn refused to part from their favourite plushie, a unicorn in the image of Swift Wind.

Glimmer chuckled. "Don't worry Finn... I still sleep with Kowl even after all these years and *I'm* thirty-eight."

"Yeah Finn, you can keep Lil' Swifty until you're ninety as far as I care," Catra reassured her child. "Now come on, let's get this stuff up there." She crawled up the ladder and pushed open the attic door.

As she climbed up into the darkened attic, Melog followed her up. Catra stood up in the darkness, her feline senses aiding her to see

but she knew it would be better to shine at least a little light up here. Melog responded to Catra's thoughts and her mane glowed a bright blue hue, illuminating a small portion of the vast attic around her. And to Catra's shock and amazement… The attic was not as bare as she thought.

Surrounding her from nearly every angle were dozens upon dozens of old books, gathering dust. Where they had come from... Catra had no idea. As far as she knew, this was the first time anyone had been inside this attic, but clearly someone had been here before. She looked down to the hole behind her. "Sparkles, Finn, I think you'd better come up here.... I think we have a mystery on our hands."

Finn went up the ladder, followed by Glimmer. The Queen conjured a small sphere of magical light to act as her own personal torch as she looked around the room. She too looked around, puzzled by the towering pillars of books surrounding her. "What... What are these?"

"That's the question on everybody's lips, Sparkles," Catra remarked.

"No one's been up here since I had this place built," Glimmer pondered, walking down the aisles of books. "Where did these come from?"

Finn grabbed one of the books and opened it... and saw a familiar sight. "Hey, Mama, isn't this Mom's handwriting?"

Catra took the book into her hands and indeed, on the first page was a whole series of notes written in Adora's handwriting. She read it aloud a little. "The caves beneath Brightmoon go on for a lot deeper than I thought... I wonder if at one point in the past, the Crystal Castle was connected to these catacombs." She scrolled to another page. "Mount Eternabloom's peak is among the third highest on Etheria... I'm probably one of the first to summit it in centuries." She beamed. "I know what this is! This was for your mom's survey of the planet!"

This book in particular was a journal of Adora's cartography work, from when she started making maps of Etheria a couple years before Finn was born. Adora had helped to make the most complete map of Etheria ever seen at that point and to this day, people still used it as a resource for journeys all across the planet. Catra remembered being so proud of her wife when she finally finished it.

Glimmer picked up another book, seeing it was also in Adora's handwriting, notes around two drawings of two outfits.... which Glimmer recognised as the ones Adora and Catra wore to the first ball after the war and had worn them many times since then over the years. "This is also Adora's," she said, before reading aloud. "I don't know if I've got the details right, but I really want to make sure that vision I saw becomes real. I hope Catra doesn't mind wearing shoes."

"Well I'll be damned," Catra remarked, walking over to Glimmer as the pink-haired Queen skipped to near the end of the journal.

"Another magical storm hit Salineas today, seems to be yet another side effect of the magic being released from the Heart Of Etheria," Glimmer read. "I keep feeling this insecurity, that even by saving the planet, I'm still causing problems for people. Fortunately, no one died in that storm but I still feel guilty. Catra... Stars, I don't know what I'd do without Catra. I know I'd be feeling a lot worse if she wasn't here with me to get me through this. I'll keep cataloguing these, at least so I can look back on them to be prepared if more freaky stuff like this happens in the future."

"I remember that storm," Catra stated. "Adora was beating herself up about it all night when we got back from cleaning Salineas up."

Glimmer scrolled through the book again. "Looks like this one in particular stopped about ten years ago," she said. "Adora was very thorough."

Catra looked around, coming to the slow realisation that each and every one of these journals had been written by Adora. She wondered when her wife even had time to write this much, considering how many books there were... and why did she keep these a secret? No, if anyone deserved their privacy, it was Adora. She might have been the woman who saved the universe, but she also deserved the right to a life of her own.

Just then, the three of them heard a voice coming from down below.

"Guys, are you up there?"

It was Adora, naturally.

"Yeah, we're up here!" Catra called down to her wife. "Could you come up here, Adora? We uh... We gotta talk."

The blonde quickly climbed up the ladder, poking her head up out of the hole. When she saw Catra holding one of the books in her hands and the piles of books surrounding them, she blushed in embarrassment. "Ah... you uh... I see you finally found my journals." She rubbed the back of her head sheepishly as she pulled herself up into the attic. "I sort of hoped you'd never stumble onto them... I kinda wrote a *lot*."

“Yeah, we noticed,” Catra remarked in her usual way.

"You really wrote all these, Mom?" Finn wondered.

Adora nodded. "That's right, Finny. Each and every one of these was written by me."

"How long have you been writing these?" Catra wondered. "There's gotta be at least a three-hundred up here."

Sighing, Adora finally came clean with her wife. "I started writing my first journal the day we got back to Brightmoon after we defeated Prime. I thought... with everything at peace now and finally being happy with you, I wanted to make sure I never forgot

a single moment of it, so I started writing everything down. I wanted to make sure I remembered what I knew was going to be the happiest times of my life. But then one thing led to another and the happy times never exactly stopped and.... well, I think you can gather the rest. I just thought it was gonna be one diary... but one thing led to another and the next thing I knew, I was making journals for basically everything that was on my mind."

"When did you stick these all up in the attic, Mom?" Finn asked.

"I didn't... at first. I used to hide them under our bed and write in them before I went to sleep every night. But it quickly turned into a bit of a mess under there, so when the suite finally got built not long after I married your Mama, I just started throwing them all up into the attic. It felt like the best place for them since well... it's not like anyone was ever going to go up there, until today."

Glimmer sighed. "I'm sorry Adora... Catra and I flicked through one just now and it looked like you put some pretty personal stuff in there. We didn't mean to violate your privacy."

"No, no, Glimmer, it's fine," Adora reassured her friend. "It's not like I'd ever keep any of this stuff from you."

"That's no excuse, you've earned the right to a private life and to make as many of these as you want," Catra argued. "We had no right to go snooping in them."

"Catra, I'm not mad, I promise," Adora said softly, kissing her wife on the cheek.

Catra sighed in relief. "But we still gotta make some room for Finn's stuff. There's no way it's gonna fit in here with *all* these books of yours."

It was then that a lightbulb went on in Finn's head. "I got an idea! Auntie Glimmer, do you remember when you were telling me about the royal archives here in Brightmoon? About how there's

tons of old documents and scrolls and sacred texts preserved there?"

"Oh yes!" Glimmer realised. "That's a great idea, Finn!"

"Wait, *what's* a great idea?" Adora asked, confused.

"Storing your journals in the royal archives and preserving them of course!" Glimmer stated. "They *are* the journals of She-Ra after all. Future historians will find them absolutely fascinating for sure!"

"Woah, historians?! But... most of these are my *barely* coherent rambles! I bet half of them don't even make a lick of sense!"

"It's still She-Ra's life in her own words, Adora, that's a lot more important than you realise," Glimmer stated.

"They're the journals of the most important, most special, most wonderful woman to ever walk the face of this planet," Catra reminded her wife. "Who wouldn't want to keep them preserved for future generations?"

"And if it makes you feel better, I'll make sure they're kept sealed for a good long while after you're gone," Glimmer stated. "I'll make it a royal decree that unless it's you, Catra or Finn, no one is allowed to even touch these journals until at least twenty years after all three of you have died."

"That's... a bit morbid," Adora admitted.

"Don't worry about it," Catra teased, nudging her elbow and grinning. "But I think it's a pretty good idea."

Adora thought for a moment. It... was a comforting thought to know that even a thousand years into the future, people would still be able to know the full story of her life, to know her life in her own words. It was a luxury that Mara unfortunately never got to have after she had passed, being misremembered by history and Light Hope's reprogramming as a dangerous villain, when in

reality she was a tragic hero who gave her life for the world she'd loved. Adora knew that history would not repeat itself with her, that history would always remember her as the woman who restored magic to Etheria and the universe, that she would be remembered as the wonderful person everyone told her she was.

"Alright... I'll accept," Adora finally said, after thinking long and hard about it.

Catra grabbed Adora's cheeks and kissed her deeply. "That's my girl!"

"I'm proud of you, Mom," Finn said, hugging Adora from the side.

"Aww," Adora melted.

"I'll make the preparations as soon as we're done here," Glimmer stated.

Catra shot Adora a toothy grin again. "Now if you don't mind, darling, now that you're here... would you mind turning into She-Ra and making good use of those gorgeous magically enhanced muscles of yours? We still have a job to do."

Adora giggled. "Okay, one She-Ra coming right up!"

End Notes

Finally back to writing and posting again after a bit of an absence. Picked up this prompt from TheSofterGentlerMe a while back while I was away and I'm finally glad to be getting around to writing it. It's so good to finally be back.

As always, if you liked the fic, please be sure to comment!

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